

# WHOIS

We can consider [WHOIS](#) as the "white pages" for domain names. It is a TCP-based transaction-oriented query/response protocol listening on TCP port 43 by default. We can use it for querying databases containing domain names, IP addresses, or autonomous systems and provide information services to Internet users. The protocol is defined in [RFC 3912](#). The first WHOIS directory was created in the early 1970s by [Elizabeth Feinler](#) and her team working out of Stanford University's Network Information Center (NIC). Together with her team, they created domains divided into categories based upon a computer's physical address. We can read more about the fascinating history of WHOIS [here](#).

The WHOIS domain lookups allow us to retrieve information about the domain name of an already registered domain. The [Internet Corporation of Assigned Names and Numbers \(ICANN\)](#) requires that accredited registrars enter the holder's contact information, the domain's creation, and expiration dates, and other information in the Whois database immediately after registering a domain. In simple terms, the Whois database is a searchable list of all domains currently registered worldwide.

WHOIS lookups were initially performed using command-line tools. Nowadays, many web-based tools exist, but command-line options often give us the most control over our queries and help filter and sort the resultant output. [Sysinternals WHOIS](#) for Windows or Linux [WHOIS](#) command-line utility are our preferred tools for gathering information. However, there are some online versions like [whois.domaintools.com](#) we can also use.

We would get the following response from the previous command to run a `whois` lookup against the `facebook.com` domain. An example of this `whois` command is:

```
dbcypn@htb[/htb]$ export TARGET="facebook.com" # Assign our target to an environment variable
dbcypn@htb[/htb]$ whois $TARGET
```

```
Domain Name: FACEBOOK.COM
Registry Domain ID: 2320948_DOMAIN_COM-VRSN
Registrar WHOIS Server: whois.registrarsafe.com
Registrar URL: https://www.registrarsafe.com
Updated Date: 2021-09-22T19:33:41Z
Creation Date: 1997-03-29T05:00:00Z
Registrar Registration Expiration Date: 2030-03-30T04:00:00Z
Registrar: RegistrarSafe, LLC
Registrar IANA ID: 3237
Registrar Abuse Contact Email: abusecomplaints@registrarsafe.com
Registrar Abuse Contact Phone: +1.6503087004
Domain Status: clientDeleteProhibited https://www.icann.org/epp#clientDeleteProhibited
Domain Status: clientTransferProhibited https://www.icann.org/epp#clientTransferProhibited
Domain Status: clientUpdateProhibited https://www.icann.org/epp#clientUpdateProhibited
Domain Status: serverDeleteProhibited https://www.icann.org/epp#serverDeleteProhibited
Domain Status: serverTransferProhibited https://www.icann.org/epp#serverTransferProhibited
Domain Status: serverUpdateProhibited https://www.icann.org/epp#serverUpdateProhibited
Registry Registrant ID:
Registrant Name: Domain Admin
Registrant Organization: Facebook, Inc.
Registrant Street: 1601 Willow Rd
Registrant City: Menlo Park
Registrant State/Province: CA
Registrant Postal Code: 94025
Registrant Country: US
Registrant Phone: +1.6505434800
Registrant Phone Ext:
Registrant Fax: +1.6505434800
Registrant Fax Ext:
```

**Integrated Terminal**

```
[us-academy-1]-[10.10.14.153]-[htb-ac-819475@htb-5syuu2go3]-[~]
```

```
[*]$  
Admin Organization: Facebook, Inc.  
Admin Street: 1601 Willow Rd  
Admin City: Menlo Park  
Admin State/Province: CA  
Admin Postal Code: 94025  
Admin Country: US  
Admin Phone: +1.6505434800  
Admin Phone Ext:  
Admin Fax: +1.6505434800  
Admin Fax Ext:  
Admin Email: domain@fb.com  
Registry Tech ID:  
Tech Name: Domain Admin  
Tech Organization: Facebook, Inc.  
Tech Street: 1601 Willow Rd  
Tech City: Menlo Park  
Tech State/Province: CA  
Tech Postal Code: 94025  
Tech Country: US  
Tech Phone: +1.6505434800  
Tech Phone Ext:  
Tech Fax: +1.6505434800  
Tech Fax Ext:  
Tech Email: domain@fb.com  
Name Server: C.NS.FACEBOOK.COM  
Name Server: B.NS.FACEBOOK.COM  
Name Server: A.NS.FACEBOOK.COM  
Name Server: D.NS.FACEBOOK.COM  
DNSSEC: unsigned  
  
<SNIP>
```

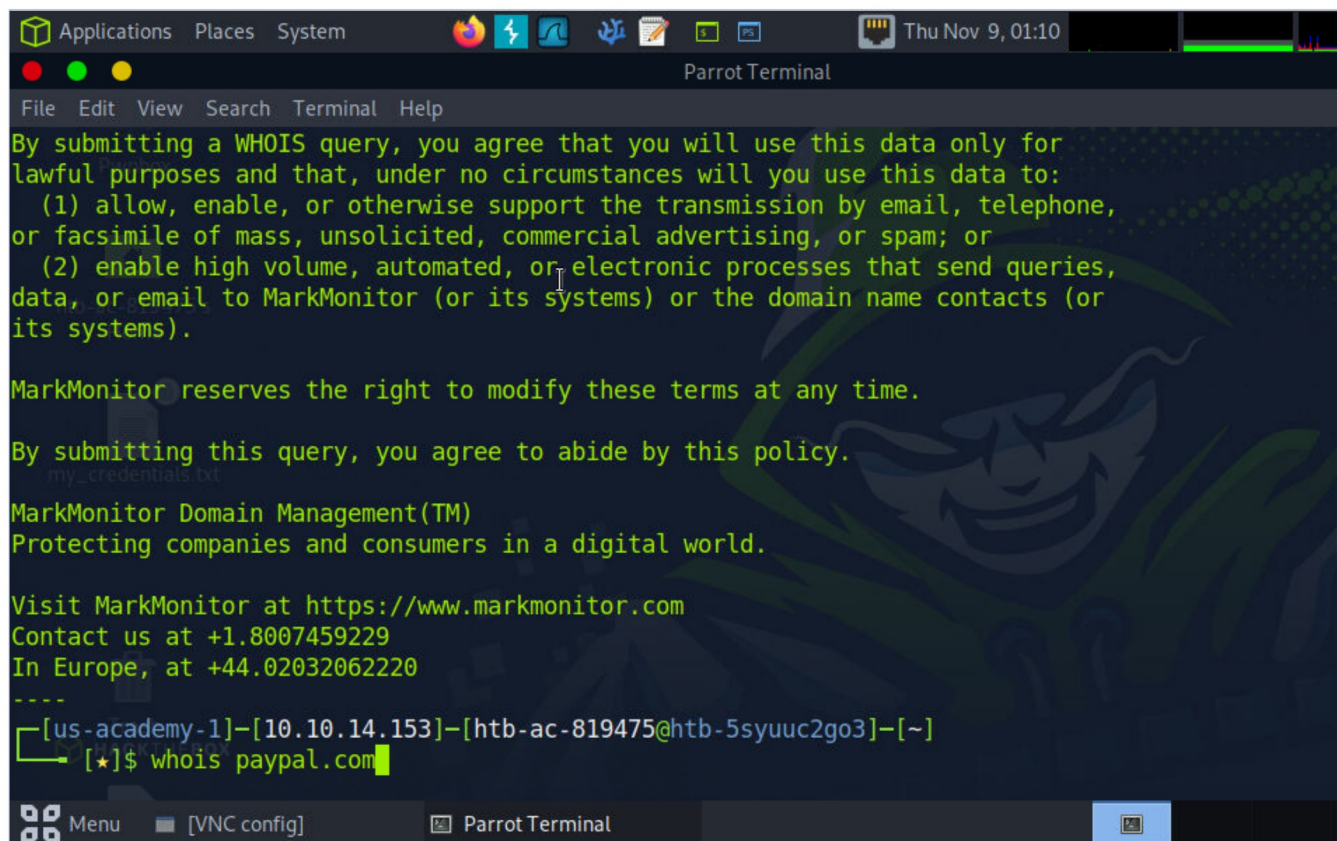
We can gather the same data using `whois.exe` from Windows Sysinternals:

```
C:\htb> whois.exe facebook.com  
  
Whois v1.21 - Domain information lookup  
Copyright (C) 2005-2019 Mark Russinovich  
Sysinternals - www.sysinternals.com  
  
Connecting to COM.whois-servers.net...  
  
WHOIS Server: whois.registrarsafe.com  
Registrar URL: http://www.registrarsafe.com  
Updated Date: 2021-09-22T19:33:41Z  
Creation Date: 1997-03-29T05:00:00Z  
Registry Expiry Date: 2030-03-30T04:00:00Z  
Registrar: RegistrarSafe, LLC  
Registrar IANA ID: 3237  
Registrar Abuse Contact Email: abusecomplaints@registrarsafe.com  
Registrar Abuse Contact Phone: +1-650-308-7004  
Domain Status: clientDeleteProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientDeleteProhibited  
Domain Status: clientTransferProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientTransferProhibited  
Domain Status: clientUpdateProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientUpdateProhibited  
Domain Status: serverDeleteProhibited https://icann.org/epp#serverDeleteProhibited  
Domain Status: serverTransferProhibited https://icann.org/epp#serverTransferProhibited  
Domain Status: serverUpdateProhibited https://icann.org/epp#serverUpdateProhibited  
Name Server: A.NS.FACEBOOK.COM  
Name Server: B.NS.FACEBOOK.COM  
Name Server: C.NS.FACEBOOK.COM  
Name Server: D.NS.FACEBOOK.COM  
DNSSEC: unsigned  
URL of the ICANN Whois Inaccuracy Complaint Form: https://www.icann.org/wicf/  
>>> Last update of whois database: 2021-10-11T06:03:10Z <<<
```

From this output, we have gathered the following information:

|                         |                                         |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Organisation            | Facebook, Inc.                          |
| Locations               | US, 94025 Menlo Park, CA, 1601 Willo Rd |
| Domain Email address    | domain@fb.com                           |
| Registrar Email address | abusecomplaints@registrarsafe.com       |
| Phone number            | +1.6505434800                           |
| Language                | English (US)                            |
| Registrar               | RegistrarSafe, LLC                      |
| New Domain              | fb.com                                  |
| DNSSEC                  | unsigned                                |
| Name servers            | A.NS.FACEBOOK.COM                       |
|                         | B.NS.FACEBOOK.COM                       |
|                         | C.NS.FACEBOOK.COM                       |
|                         | D.NS.FACEBOOK.COM                       |

Though none of this information on its own is enough for us to mount an attack, it is essential data that we want to note down for later.



```
Applications Places System Thu Nov 9, 01:10
Parrot Terminal
File Edit View Search Terminal Help
By submitting a WHOIS query, you agree that you will use this data only for
lawful purposes and that, under no circumstances will you use this data to:
  (1) allow, enable, or otherwise support the transmission by email, telephone,
or facsimile of mass, unsolicited, commercial advertising, or spam; or
  (2) enable high volume, automated, or electronic processes that send queries,
data, or email to MarkMonitor (or its systems) or the domain name contacts (or
its systems).

MarkMonitor reserves the right to modify these terms at any time.

By submitting this query, you agree to abide by this policy.

my_credentials.txt
MarkMonitor Domain Management(TM)
Protecting companies and consumers in a digital world.

Visit MarkMonitor at https://www.markmonitor.com
Contact us at +1.8007459229
In Europe, at +44.02032062220
----
[us-academy-1]-[10.10.14.153]-[htb-ac-819475@htb-5syuuc2go3]-[~]
[*]$ whois paypal.com
```

Full Screen Terminate Reset

Connected to htb-5syuuc2go3:1 (htb-ac-819475)

Integrated Terminal

## Questions

[Cheat Sheet](#)

Answer the question(s) below to complete this Section and earn cubes!

+ 0

Perform a WHOIS lookup against the paypal.com domain. What is the registrar Internet Assigned Numbers Authority (IANA) ID number?

292



Submit

+ 0

What is the admin email contact for the tesla.com domain (also in-scope for the Tesla bug bounty program)?

admin@dnstinations.com



Submit

← Previous

Next →

✓ Mark Complete & Next

[Cheat Sheet](#)[Go to Questions](#)

## Table of Contents

Information Gathering



### Passive Information Gathering

WHOIS



DNS

Passive Subdomain Enumeration

Passive Infrastructure Identification

### Active Information Gathering

Active Infrastructure Identification

Active Subdomain Enumeration

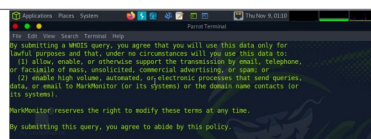
Virtual Hosts

Crawling

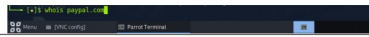
### Putting it all Together

Information Gathering - Web - Skills Assessment

## My Workstation



## Integrated Terminal

A terminal window with a dark background. The prompt is root@kali:~#. The command cat /etc/passwd has been entered and executed, showing the contents of the /etc/passwd file.InteractTerminateReset

Life Left: 110m

